Velocity tells us more than speed

GUIDED NOTES / use with the projected diagram Name _____

A SAY THE WORD

Signed area / ES: área con signo / PT: área com sinal

Above zero adds displacement; below zero subtracts it.

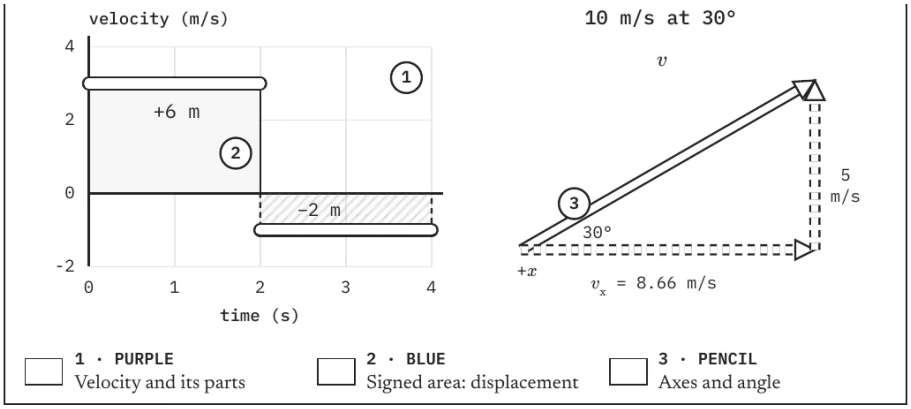
Also on your note page: Distance, Component, Angle θ.

B READ THE RELATIONSHIP

Displacement = signed area under a velocity–time graph

As you read, find: above · below · area.

C TRACE THE ORIGINAL FIGURE



Use the numbered key. Trace one feature. Tell your partner what it means.

D FOLLOW THE WORKED EXAMPLE

A cart moves at +3 m/s for 2 s , then −1 m/s for 2 s . Find its displacement and total distance.

Given v 1 = +3 m/s v 2 = −1 m/s 2 s per interval

Rule Use areas because each interval has steady v .

Work Δ x = 3(2) − 1(2) distance = 6 + 2

Answer +4 m ; 8 m Return travel reduces Δ x , not distance.

E SAVE FOR THE FINAL MEETING

For fictional XJ, the area of a velocity–time graph gives a change in position. Components separate motion toward Earth from motion across its line of sight.

Read the physics: Signed area

SUPPORTED READING / read one part, then point to the evidence Name _____

01 PICTURE IT

Read the vertical axis first. A flat line on a velocity–time graph means steady velocity. A flat line above zero means the object is moving.

02 HOW IT WORKS

Shade the region between velocity and the time axis. For steady velocity, multiply velocity by time. Add areas above zero; subtract the sizes of areas below zero. For distance, add all the sizes.

03 WHAT TO CHECK

A diagonal velocity has two components. For an angle measured from +x, use cosine for the x part and sine for the y part.

04 TRY THE EXAMPLE FROM YOUR NOTES

A cart moves at +3 m/s for 2 s , then −1 m/s for 2 s . Find its displacement and total distance. +4 m ; 8 m Return travel reduces Δ x , not distance.

Model check: Displacement = signed area under a velocity–time graph.

05 CONNECT TO XJ

For fictional XJ, the area of a velocity–time graph gives a change in position. Components separate motion toward Earth from motion across its line of sight.

SAY IT BEFORE YOU WRITE

Which shaded part subtracts from displacement? The area is ___ because it is ___ zero.

Build the word. Draw the idea.

STUDENT CHOICE / FRONT / OPENING MEETING Name _____

A FRAYER MODEL

Signed area / ES: área con signo / PT: área com sinal

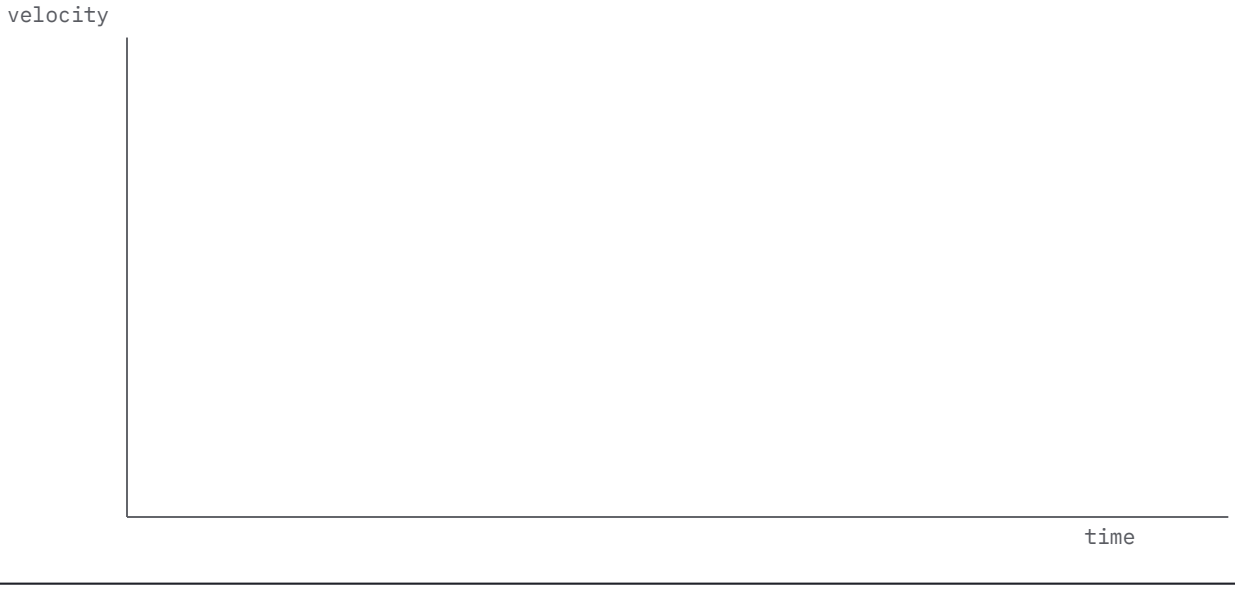
Say it in any language. Draw or use a few words. Use the notes to check your idea.

Meaning	How can you tell?
To me, signed area means …	On a velocity–time graph, how can you tell which area to subtract? I subtract the area that lies ___.
Example or sketch	**Non-example**
I see it when …	This looks close, but …

B DRAW WITH YOUR TEACHER

Draw and shade opposite-side rectangles. Put m/s on the vertical and s on the horizontal axis.

Labels you can use: above · below · area.



Tell a partner: The area is ___ because it is ___ zero.

On assignment: Signed area

SECTION E / BACK / FINAL MEETING ONLY Name _____

A moving camera follows a model at +3 km/s for 2 s, then −1 km/s for 2 s. The editor needs the end location and the total footage distance.

PICK A JOB / DELIVER ONE PRODUCT

☐ **Tracking engineer**

Shade both parts of a velocity graph. Give the camera operator the final change from start, including direction.

☐ **Replay producer**

Storyboard the outbound and return shots. Tell the editor total distance and net movement; mark which part plays in reverse direction.

Word bank: above · below · area.

Try: “Our desk recommends ___. This mark shows ___.”

One partner makes the graphic; one delivers the first call. Show your evidence to the crew or the audience.

OUR GRAPHIC / COMMAND OR ON-AIR CUE

INCOMING UPDATE / WAIT FOR YOUR TEACHER

Listen to the new report. Switch speakers. Keep or change your call; point to the new evidence.

“We first said ___. Now we ___ because ___.”

Editor’s check: Turn the axis ninety degrees. Explain why transverse velocity needs its own graph.